

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL AWITI-DELEGATE

EPS 110 RECENT PAST PAPERS WITH ANSWERS BY SIR OTONDE MICHAEL-DELEGATE

QUESTION ONE

a) Structuralism used introspection to understand human behavior. Identify four limitations associated with this method. (4 marks)

Answer:

1. It is highly subjective – results depend on personal interpretation.
2. It cannot be verified by other researchers (lack of reliability).
3. It relies on individuals' ability to accurately describe their thoughts and feelings.
4. It cannot be used to study children, animals, or people with communication difficulties.

b) Explain what the following branches of modern psychology are concerned with:

i. Educational Psychology

Answer:

Educational psychology is concerned with how people learn in educational settings. It studies teaching methods, learning processes, motivation, classroom management, and how to improve academic performance.

ii. Counseling Psychology

Answer:

Counseling psychology focuses on helping individuals cope with emotional, social, and personal challenges. It deals with issues such as stress, relationships, career guidance, and mental well-being.

c) Using relevant examples, explain any two ways in which the knowledge acquired in this psychology unit will help you in practice as a teacher. (4 marks)

Answer:

1. Understanding learners' differences – A teacher can apply knowledge of individual differences to adapt teaching methods to suit slow and fast learners.
2. Classroom management – Knowledge of behavior and motivation helps a teacher maintain discipline and encourage positive behavior in class.

d) Explain three educational implications of Howard Gardner's multiple intelligence theory. (6 marks)

Answer:

1. Use varied teaching methods – Teachers should use different instructional strategies (e.g., music, group work, visual aids) to address different intelligences.
2. Diversify assessment methods – Assessment should not rely only on written exams but include projects, presentations, and practical work.
3. Encourage development of all talents – Schools should support talents such as music, sports, and art, not just academic ability.

e) Highlight two contributions of classical conditioning to our understanding of learning, providing real-life examples of each. (2 marks)

Answer:

1. It explains how emotional responses are learned – For example, a child bitten by a dog may develop fear of all dogs.
2. It shows how habits are formed through association – For example, students may feel hungry when they hear the school lunch bell.

QUESTION TWO

a) Describe any four types of sex chromosome trisomy. (8 marks)

Answer:

1. Triple X Syndrome (XXX) – A female with three X chromosomes; may have mild learning difficulties but often appears physically normal.
2. Klinefelter Syndrome (XXY) – A male with an extra X chromosome; may have reduced testosterone, infertility, and learning difficulties.
3. XYY Syndrome – A male with an extra Y chromosome; may be taller than average and sometimes experience learning or behavioral challenges.
4. Mosaic Trisomy – Some cells have an extra sex chromosome while others are normal; effects vary depending on the proportion of affected cells.

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b) Students show a wide range of emotions during the course of stay in school. Mention any three common emotions and explain their functions to a student who uses them. (6 marks)

Answer:

1. Happiness – Encourages participation, motivation, and positive relationships with peers and teachers.
2. Fear/Anxiety – Helps students prepare for exams or avoid danger by increasing alertness.
3. Anger – Signals unfair treatment and may motivate a student to seek solutions to problems.

c) Conflicts are seen as unnecessary in human interactions. However, as a psychologist, they serve some benefits. Cite and explain such benefits. (6 marks)

Answer:

1. Promotes problem-solving – Conflict encourages individuals to address issues and find solutions.
2. Encourages personal growth – People learn communication and negotiation skills.
3. Strengthens relationships – When resolved properly, conflict can improve understanding and trust between individuals.

QUESTION THREE

a) Citing an example for each, describe the two categories of stress. (8 marks)

Answer:

1. **Eustress (Positive Stress)** – This is beneficial stress that motivates an individual to perform better.
Example: A student feeling slightly nervous before an exam studies harder and performs well.
2. **Distress (Negative Stress)** – This is harmful stress that overwhelms an individual and affects performance negatively.
Example: A student experiencing family problems becomes anxious and fails to concentrate in class.

b) Using relevant examples, give four techniques that a teacher can train learners to use for stress management in a school. (8 marks)

Answer:

1. **Time management skills** – Teaching students to create study timetables to avoid last-minute cramming.

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2. **Relaxation techniques** – Deep breathing or short meditation before exams to reduce anxiety.
3. **Physical exercise** – Encouraging participation in sports to relieve tension.
4. **Problem-solving skills** – Helping students break big tasks into smaller manageable parts.

c) The four general criteria that psychologists use to identify abnormal behavior are violation of social norms, statistical rarity, personal distress, and maladaptive behavior. Explain the underlined concepts. (4 marks)

Answer:

1. **Violation of social norms** – Behavior that goes against accepted standards or expectations of society.
2. **Statistical rarity** – Behavior that is very uncommon or rare compared to the majority of people.
3. **Personal distress** – When an individual experiences significant emotional suffering due to their behavior.
4. **Maladaptive behavior** – Behavior that interferes with a person's ability to function effectively in daily life.

QUESTION FOUR

a) Using a suitable classroom example, describe how understanding the motivational cycle can help you as a teacher address student's needs and improve their learning experience. (6 marks)

Answer:

The motivational cycle involves need, drive, goal-directed behavior, and satisfaction.

For example, if students feel hungry (need), they become restless (drive). A teacher who understands this may schedule a short break (goal-directed action). After eating, students feel satisfied and concentrate better (goal attainment).

In academic terms, if students desire good grades (need), they are motivated to study (drive). The teacher can provide guidance and resources (goal-directed support), leading to achievement and satisfaction. This improves motivation and learning.

b) Describe the following schedules of reinforcement, providing classroom-based examples for each: (8 marks)

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i. Fixed-ratio schedule

Reinforcement is given after a fixed number of responses.

Example: A teacher rewards a student after completing five assignments.

ii. Variable-ratio schedule

Reinforcement is given after an unpredictable number of responses.

Example: A teacher gives praise randomly after several correct answers.

iii. Fixed-interval schedule

Reinforcement is given after a fixed period of time.

Example: Weekly quizzes every Friday.

iv. Variable-interval schedule

Reinforcement is given at unpredictable time intervals.

Example: Surprise class checks or random praise during lessons.

c) Explain how the following factors shape our perception of the world: (6 marks)

i. Perceptual constancy

Allows us to perceive objects as stable and consistent despite changes in size, shape, or color due to distance or lighting.

ii. Context characteristics

The environment or surrounding situation influences how we interpret stimuli. For example, behavior may be seen as normal in one setting but inappropriate in another.

iii. Culture

Cultural background influences how we interpret experiences, gestures, language, and social interactions.

1. (a) Outline two main differences between the following terms as used in Psychology. (10 marks)

(i) Principles of generalization and extinction

Answer:

- **Generalization** refers to the tendency of a learned response to occur in response to stimuli that are similar to the original conditioned stimulus.
- **Extinction** refers to the gradual disappearance of a learned response when reinforcement is no longer provided.

(ii) Klinefelter's and Turner's Syndrome

Answer:

- **Klinefelter's Syndrome** affects males and is caused by an extra X chromosome (XXY). Individuals are genetically male but may have reduced testosterone and infertility.
- **Turner's Syndrome** affects females and is caused by a missing X chromosome (XO). Individuals are genetically female but may have short stature and infertility.

(iii) Sex Chromosome Trisomy and Autosomal monosomy

Answer:

- **Sex Chromosome Trisomy** is a condition where there is an extra sex chromosome (e.g., XXX, XXY, XYY).
- **Autosomal Monosomy** is a condition where one chromosome from a non-sex chromosome pair is missing.

(iv) Structuralism and Functionalism

Answer:

- **Structuralism** focuses on analyzing the structure of the mind by breaking down mental processes into basic components using introspection.
- **Functionalism** focuses on how mental processes help individuals adapt to their environment.

(v) Fluid intelligence and Crystallized intelligence

Answer:

- **Fluid intelligence** is the ability to solve new problems and think logically without relying on prior knowledge.
- **Crystallized intelligence** is the ability to use learned knowledge, skills, and experience.

(b) Give four reasons why psychology is a science. (4 marks)

Answer:

1. It uses systematic observation.
2. It relies on experimentation and empirical evidence.
3. It follows scientific methods such as hypothesis testing.
4. Its findings can be tested and verified by other researchers.

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(c) Outline any three sources of frustration. (3 marks)

Answer:

1. Environmental obstacles (e.g., lack of resources).
2. Personal limitations (e.g., lack of skills or ability).
3. Social conflicts (e.g., disagreement with peers).

(d) Explain any three factors that influence human perception. (3 marks)

Answer:

1. Past experience – Previous knowledge affects how we interpret stimuli.
2. Motivation and needs – What we need or desire influences perception.
3. Culture – Cultural background shapes how we interpret events and behaviors.

2. (a) Distinguish between Developmental Psychology and Cognitive Psychology. (2 marks)

Answer:

- **Developmental Psychology** studies human growth and changes across the lifespan.
- **Cognitive Psychology** studies mental processes such as thinking, memory, perception, and problem-solving.

(b) Using relevant examples describe the four goals of Psychology. (8 marks)

Answer:

1. **Description** – Observing and describing behavior.
Example: Recording how students behave during exams.
2. **Explanation** – Identifying causes of behavior.
Example: Explaining that anxiety may cause poor performance.
3. **Prediction** – Forecasting future behavior.
Example: Predicting that a student who studies regularly will perform well.
4. **Control** – Influencing or modifying behavior.
Example: Using reinforcement to improve classroom discipline.

(c) Explain five functions of emotions. (10 marks)

Answer:

1. **Motivational function** – Emotions energize behavior (e.g., fear motivates escape).

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2. **Communication function** – Facial expressions communicate feelings to others.
3. **Adaptive function** – Emotions help individuals respond to danger or opportunity.
4. **Social bonding function** – Love and affection strengthen relationships.
5. **Decision-making function** – Emotions influence choices and judgments.

ANSWER KEY

Question 3

(a) Describe two problems of intelligence tests (4 marks)

Answer:

1. **Cultural Bias:** Intelligence tests often reflect the cultural values and knowledge of dominant groups, disadvantaging individuals from different cultural backgrounds. For example, a test that uses idioms or cultural references specific to Western education may unfairly penalize non-Western test-takers who possess equivalent intelligence but lack familiarity with those specific cultural markers.
2. **Limited Scope of Intelligence:** Traditional intelligence tests measure only certain types of cognitive abilities (typically verbal and logical-mathematical) while ignoring other important forms of intelligence such as emotional intelligence, creative intelligence, and practical intelligence. This results in an incomplete assessment of a person's overall intellectual capabilities and potential.

(b) With relevant examples explain the three categories of psychological conflict (6 marks)

Answer:

1. **Approach-Approach Conflict:** This occurs when a person must choose between two equally desirable alternatives. Example: A student receiving admission offers from two equally prestigious universities must choose one, creating internal conflict despite both options being positive.
2. **Avoidance-Avoidance Conflict:** This arises when a person must choose between two equally undesirable alternatives. Example: An employee facing the choice between accepting an undesirable job transfer or resigning from their position experiences this type of conflict, as both outcomes have negative consequences.
3. **Approach-Avoidance Conflict:** This occurs when a single option has both desirable and undesirable aspects. Example: A person may desire a promotion at work (approach) but fear the increased responsibilities and reduced leisure time (avoidance), creating internal conflict about the same goal.

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(c) Using relevant examples, explain the five general structures of intelligence (10 marks)

Answer:

1. **Linguistic Intelligence:** The ability to use language effectively in speaking, writing, and comprehension. Example: Poets, authors, and public speakers demonstrate high linguistic intelligence through their ability to articulate ideas, create meaning, and influence others through words.
2. **Logical-Mathematical Intelligence:** The capacity to reason, calculate, and think in logical sequences. Example: Mathematicians, scientists, and engineers use logical-mathematical intelligence to solve complex problems, analyze data, and develop theoretical frameworks.
3. **Spatial Intelligence:** The ability to perceive and manipulate visual and spatial information. Example: Architects, artists, and pilots demonstrate spatial intelligence through their capacity to visualize three-dimensional structures, navigate environments, and create visual representations.
4. **Bodily-Kinesthetic Intelligence:** The ability to control body movements and manipulate objects skillfully. Example: Athletes, dancers, and surgeons possess high bodily-kinesthetic intelligence, using precise physical coordination and motor control in their respective fields.
5. **Personal Intelligence** (comprising intrapersonal and interpersonal):
 - **Intrapersonal:** Understanding one's own emotions, motivations, and self-awareness. Example: Therapists and counselors use intrapersonal intelligence to understand their own emotional responses and biases.
 - **Interpersonal:** The ability to understand and interact effectively with others. Example: Leaders, teachers, and social workers demonstrate interpersonal intelligence through their capacity to empathize, communicate, and build relationships.

Question 4

(a) Differentiate Neurasthenia and Phobia (2 marks)

Answer:

Feature	Neurasthenia	Phobia
Definition	A condition of physical and mental exhaustion characterized by weakness, fatigue, and inability to work	An irrational and persistent fear of a specific object, situation, or activity
Primary Symptom	General exhaustion and fatigue	Intense, irrational fear

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Feature	Neurasthenia	Phobia
Trigger	Overwork and stress	Specific phobic stimulus

(b) Describe the Motivation Cycle (4 marks)

Answer:

The Motivation Cycle is a four-stage process that explains how motivation develops and is satisfied:

1. **Need/Drive:** A person experiences a biological or psychological need (e.g., hunger, desire for achievement), which creates a state of tension or deprivation.
2. **Goal-Directed Behavior:** The person engages in purposeful actions aimed at satisfying the need. For example, a hungry person searches for food.
3. **Goal Achievement:** The person successfully attains the goal, satisfying the need or reducing the tension.
4. **Tension Reduction/Homeostasis:** Once the need is satisfied, the psychological tension decreases, and the organism returns to a state of equilibrium until a new need emerges, restarting the cycle.

(c) Explain any six environmental causes of mental retardation (6 marks)

Answer:

1. **Nutritional Deficiency:** Inadequate nutrition, particularly deficiency in proteins, vitamins (especially B vitamins), and minerals during critical developmental periods, can impair brain development and cause intellectual disability.
2. **Infections During Pregnancy:** Maternal infections such as rubella (German measles), syphilis, and toxoplasmosis during pregnancy can cross the placental barrier and damage fetal brain development.
3. **Traumatic Brain Injury:** Severe head injuries or accidents during childhood that cause damage to the brain can result in intellectual impairment and developmental delays.
4. **Lead Exposure:** Chronic exposure to lead through contaminated water, paint, or soil, particularly in early childhood, can cause neurotoxic effects leading to cognitive impairment.
5. **Lack of Stimulation/Sensory Deprivation:** Growing up in extremely deprived environments with minimal social interaction, educational opportunities, and cognitive stimulation can result in intellectual underdevelopment.
6. **Maternal Alcohol/Drug Abuse:** Substance abuse during pregnancy, particularly alcohol (causing Fetal Alcohol Syndrome), can severely impair fetal brain development and cause intellectual disabilities.

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(d) Describe any four Long Term Defense Mechanisms (4 marks)

Answer:

1. **Sublimation:** Channeling unacceptable impulses, emotions, or energy into socially acceptable and often productive activities. Example: Converting aggressive impulses into competitive sports or channeling emotional pain into creative pursuits like writing or art.
2. **Rationalization:** Creating logical but untrue explanations for one's behavior or feelings to make them more acceptable. Example: A student who fails an exam might rationalize by saying "the exam was unfair" rather than acknowledging lack of preparation.
3. **Projection:** Attributing one's own unacceptable thoughts, feelings, or motives to other people. Example: A person with unacknowledged hostile feelings might perceive others as hostile toward them.
4. **Identification:** Adopting the characteristics, behaviors, or values of another person or group to manage anxiety or conflict. Example: A child identifying with a parent or admired figure, internalizing their values and behaviors to feel secure and connected.

(a) Four reasons to study psychology as a teacher (4 marks)

1. Understand student behavior and motivation
2. Improve classroom management
3. Facilitate effective learning using psychological principles
4. Develop emotional intelligence and self-awareness

(b) Three limitations of introspection (3 marks)

1. Subjective and biased—unreliable self-reports
2. Cannot access unconscious processes
3. Difficult to verify or replicate findings

(c) Three reasons psychology is a science (3 marks)

1. Uses systematic observation and controlled experiments
2. Develops testable theories and hypotheses
3. Builds cumulative, peer-reviewed body of evidence

(d) Distinguish between:

(i) Nature and Nurture

- **Nature:** Innate genetic/biological factors
- **Nurture:** Environmental factors shaping development

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(ii) Negative Reinforcement and Punishment

- **Negative Reinforcement:** Removing unpleasant stimulus to increase behavior
- **Punishment:** Adding unpleasant consequence to decrease behavior

(e) Three branches of modern psychology (3 marks)

1. **Educational Psychology:** Learning, motivation, classroom management
2. **Clinical Psychology:** Assessment and treatment of mental disorders
3. **Social Psychology:** Interpersonal behavior and group dynamics

(f) Three roles of emotions in teaching (3 marks)

1. Enhance memory and learning retention
2. Increase motivation and engagement
3. Create positive, supportive classroom environment

QUESTION TWO

(a) Four school-related causes of stress (4 marks)

1. Academic pressure and exam anxiety
2. Time management difficulties
3. Social pressures and peer relationships
4. Strict teachers and harsh discipline

(b) Three ways students manage stress (6 marks)

1. **Time management:** Organize work, prioritize tasks
2. **Physical activity:** Exercise, proper sleep, healthy eating
3. **Seek support:** Talk to friends, family, counselors

(c) Five defense mechanisms to cope with anxiety (10 marks)

1. **Repression:** Unconsciously forget anxiety-causing events
2. **Projection:** Attribute own anxiety to others
3. **Rationalization:** Create logical excuses for failure
4. **Regression:** Revert to childish behavior
5. **Sublimation:** Channel anxiety into productive activities

QUESTION THREE

(a) Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs in classroom (10 marks)

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1. **Physiological:** Ensure comfort, food, rest
2. **Safety:** Create secure, predictable environment
3. **Belonging:** Foster peer relationships, classroom community
4. **Esteem:** Provide recognition, success opportunities
5. **Self-actualization:** Challenge students to reach potential

Application: Meet lower needs first to enable higher-order learning.

(b) Five perspectives on abnormal behavior (10 marks)

1. **Biological:** Genetic factors, brain chemistry imbalances
2. **Psychoanalytic:** Unconscious conflicts, repressed experiences
3. **Behavioral:** Learned maladaptive habits through conditioning
4. **Cognitive:** Irrational thoughts and distorted thinking patterns
5. **Social-Cultural:** Environmental stress, poverty, discrimination

QUESTION FOUR

(a) Skinner's schedules of partial reinforcement (8 marks)

1. **Fixed Ratio:** Reinforce after fixed number of responses (e.g., praise every 5 correct answers)
2. **Variable Ratio:** Reinforce after unpredictable number of responses (most effective—highest persistence)
3. **Fixed Interval:** Reinforce first response after fixed time (e.g., weekly quizzes)
4. **Variable Interval:** Reinforce first response after unpredictable time intervals

(b) Gardner's Multiple Intelligences (8 marks)

Intelligence consists of 8 distinct types:

1. Linguistic, 2. Logical-Mathematical, 3. Spatial, 4. Bodily-Kinesthetic, 5. Musical, 6. Interpersonal, 7. Intrapersonal, 8. Naturalistic

Classroom implication: Use varied teaching methods to engage different intelligences.

(c) Four factors influencing learner perception (4 marks)

1. Previous experience and prior knowledge
2. Motivation and personal interests
3. Emotional state and mental health
4. Cultural background and values

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EPS 110: INTRODUCTION TO

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PSYCHOLOGY - PAST PAPERS WITH

ANSWERS 1

2015/2016 EXAMINATION

SECTION A - QUESTION ONE (COMPULSORY)

a) Identify any three branches of psychology. [3 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Clinical Psychology - deals with mental disorders and treatment
2. Educational Psychology - focuses on learning and teaching
3. Developmental Psychology - studies human growth from birth to old age

b) Structuralism proposed introspection as a method of studying human behaviour.

Outline any three limitations of this method. [3 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Too subjective - people's personal views differ
2. Not reliable - different people give different answers for the same thing
3. Cannot study unconscious processes - some mental activities happen without our awareness

c) Naturalistic observation is a main technique used in psychology to collect data; explain four weaknesses of using this method. [4 marks]

ANSWER:

1. No control over variables - the researcher cannot control what happens
2. Observer bias - researcher's expectations may affect what they see
3. Privacy issues - watching people without permission is unethical
4. Time consuming and expensive - takes long and costs a lot of money

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d) Using appropriate examples, distinguish between the following terms:

i) Phenotype and genotype [2 marks]

ANSWER:

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- Genotype - the genes you inherit from your parents. Example: having genes for both brown and blue eyes (Bb)

- Phenotype - the physical traits you can see. Example: actually having brown eyes

ii) Sensation and perception [2 marks]

ANSWER:

- Sensation - when your senses detect something. Example: light hitting your eyes

- Perception - making sense of what you sensed. Example: recognizing it's your friend's face

iii) Neurosis and psychosis [2 marks]

ANSWER:

- Neurosis - mild mental problem, person still knows what's real. Example: worrying too much but knowing it's excessive

- Psychosis - severe mental problem, person loses touch with reality. Example: hearing voices that don't exist

e) Discuss three characteristics of abnormal behavior. [6 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Statistical infrequency - the behavior is rare or uncommon in society. Most people don't act that way. Example: extreme paranoia is unusual.

2. Maladaptive - the behavior stops someone from living normally. It interferes with daily life, work, or relationships. Example: being too anxious to leave the house.

3. Personal distress - the behavior causes suffering to the person. They feel very upset or uncomfortable. Example: someone with OCD feels extreme anxiety.

f) Why is psychology considered a science? Give four reasons. [5 marks]

ANSWER:

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1. Uses systematic observation - psychologists observe behavior in organized ways

2. Based on evidence - conclusions come from actual data, not opinions

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3. Follows scientific method - makes hypotheses, tests them, draws conclusions
4. Can be replicated - other researchers can repeat the studies to check if results are true

SECTION B

QUESTION TWO

a) Define absolute threshold. [2 marks]

ANSWER: Absolute threshold is the smallest amount of stimulus needed for you to notice it at least 50% of the time.

b) Why is perception important to human beings? Give three reasons. [6 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Survival - helps us detect danger and stay safe. Example: seeing a car coming so you can move away.
2. Navigate environment - allows us to move around and interact with things. Example: judging distances so you don't bump into objects.
3. Social interaction - helps us understand people's expressions and body language for communication. Example: knowing when someone is angry from their face.

c) Describe the factors that affect human perception. [12 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Past experience - what we've seen before affects how we see things now. Example: if a dog bit you before, you may see all dogs as dangerous.
2. Motivation and needs - what we want or need influences what we notice. Example: when hungry, you notice food more.
3. Expectations - what we expect to see affects what we actually see. Example: a teacher expecting poor work may judge a student more harshly.
4. Culture - where we come from shapes how we see things. Different cultures interpret the same thing differently.

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5. Attention - we see clearly what we focus on and miss what we ignore. Example: focusing on

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one conversation in a noisy room.

6. Emotions - our feelings change how we see things. Example: when scared, neutral things may seem threatening.

QUESTION THREE

a) Define learning. [2 marks]

ANSWER: Learning is a fairly permanent change in behavior that comes from experience or practice.

b) Using appropriate examples, explain how a teacher can apply the principles of classical conditioning to enhance learning. [8 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Create positive associations - pair learning with pleasant things. Example: playing calm music during reading time so students associate reading with relaxation.
2. Use consistent signals - use the same cue before activities. Example: ring a bell before lessons so students automatically get ready to learn.
3. Make classroom welcoming - create a warm environment. Example: greet students warmly at the door so they associate class with positive feelings.
4. Reduce anxiety - give small quizzes before big exams so students become comfortable with testing.

c) Discuss any five factors that affect learning. [10 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Motivation - how much the learner wants to learn. Students who are motivated work harder and learn better.
2. Readiness - whether the learner is developed enough for the material. Teaching hard concepts to young children doesn't work well.

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3. Prior knowledge - what the student already knows. New learning builds on old knowledge.
4. Practice - repeating material helps learning stick. Regular practice is better than cramming.

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5. Feedback - knowing if you're right or wrong helps improve. Immediate feedback works best.

QUESTION FOUR

a) What is intelligence? [2 marks]

ANSWER: Intelligence is the ability to learn, solve problems, think abstractly, and adapt to new situations.

b) Explain nature and nurture as determinants of intelligence. [4 marks]

ANSWER:

Nature (genetics) - genes from parents affect intelligence. Twin studies show genetics play a role in IQ.

Nurture (environment) - surroundings affect intelligence. Good education, nutrition, and stimulation boost intelligence. Poor environments limit it.

c) Discuss any five teratogenic effects that may cause mental retardation. [10 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Alcohol - drinking during pregnancy causes Fetal Alcohol Syndrome. Damages baby's brain permanently, causing mental retardation.

2. Drugs - using drugs like cocaine or heroin during pregnancy harms the baby's developing brain, causing learning problems.

3. Infections - diseases like rubella or syphilis during pregnancy damage the baby's brain and cause mental retardation.

4. Malnutrition - not eating enough nutritious food during pregnancy stops the baby's brain from developing properly.

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5. Radiation - high radiation exposure during pregnancy damages brain cells and causes mental retardation.

d) Explain how a teacher can apply Abraham Maslow's first two levels of hierarchy of needs in a learning situation. [4 marks]

ANSWER:

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Level 1 - Physiological needs - Make sure students aren't hungry or uncomfortable. Example: identify hungry students and connect them to feeding programs. Ensure good ventilation and lighting in class.

Level 2 - Safety needs - Create a safe classroom where students feel secure. Example: stop bullying, have clear rules, be consistent. Students who feel safe can focus on learning.

QUESTION FIVE

a) Define frustration. [2 marks]

ANSWER: Frustration is the feeling you get when something blocks you from reaching your goal. You feel annoyed and disappointed.

b) Using appropriate examples, explain four anxiety disorders. [8 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Generalized Anxiety Disorder - worrying too much about everything for a long time.

Example: constantly worrying about work, health, money even when things are okay.

2. Panic Disorder - sudden attacks of intense fear with physical symptoms. Example: suddenly feeling terrified while shopping, heart racing, thinking you're dying.

3. Phobias - extreme fear of specific things that makes you avoid them. Example: fear of heights so bad you can't go near tall buildings.

4. OCD (Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder) - unwanted thoughts that make you do repetitive actions. Example: fear of germs makes you wash hands repeatedly until they're raw.

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c) Explain any five long-term defense mechanisms used by people to cope with frustration. [10 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Sublimation - turning negative feelings into positive activities. Example: someone with anger issues channels it into boxing or sports.

2. Compensation - making up for weakness in one area by doing well in another. Example: a student weak in academics excels in sports instead.

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3. Rationalization - giving excuses for your behavior. Example: failing an exam and saying "the test was unfair" instead of admitting you didn't study.

4. Identification - copying someone you admire. Example: a shy person acts like their confident favorite celebrity to feel better.

5. Projection - blaming others for your own feelings. Example: being dishonest but accusing others of lying.

2017/2018 EXAMINATION

QUESTION ONE (COMPULSORY)

a) Explain three goals of psychology. [3 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Description - observing and describing behavior accurately
2. Explanation - understanding why behaviors happen
3. Prediction - forecasting future behavior

b) Distinguish between the following pairs of terms:

i) Extinction and spontaneous recovery [2 marks]

ANSWER:

- Extinction - learned response disappears when not reinforced
- Spontaneous recovery - extinct response comes back after a break

ii) Absolute threshold and differential threshold [2 marks]

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ANSWER:

- Absolute threshold - minimum stimulus needed to detect something
- Differential threshold - minimum change needed to notice a difference

iii) Forensic psychology and cognitive psychology [2 marks]

ANSWER:

- Forensic psychology - psychology applied to legal and criminal issues
- Cognitive psychology - studies mental processes like memory and thinking

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c) Explain two characteristics of motivated behavior. [4 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Goal-directed - behavior aims at achieving something specific. Example: studying to pass an exam.
2. Persistent - person keeps trying until they reach the goal. Example: an athlete training hard despite being tired.

d) Give two differences between classical and operant conditioning. [4 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Type of behavior:

- o Classical: involuntary/automatic responses (like salivating)
- o Operant: voluntary/deliberate actions (like pressing a button)

2. How learning happens:

- o Classical: through association between two stimuli
- o Operant: through consequences (rewards or punishments)

e) Highlight four disadvantages of experimental research. [4 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Artificial setting - lab isn't like real life
2. Ethical limits - can't experiment on harmful things
3. People act differently when watched

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4. Expensive and time-consuming

f) Define introspection and identify four of its limitations. [5 marks]

ANSWER:

Definition: Looking inward and reporting your own thoughts and feelings.

Limitations:

1. Too subjective - can't verify personal reports
2. Unreliable - different people give different answers

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3. Can't access unconscious mind

4. Observing changes the experience itself

g) Citing relevant examples, differentiate between sex chromosomal monosomy and sex chromosomal trisomy. [4 marks]

ANSWER:

Monosomy - having only one sex chromosome (45 total). Example: Turner syndrome (XO) - females with one X chromosome, short height, can't have children.

Trisomy - having three sex chromosomes (47 total). Example: Klinefelter syndrome (XXY) - males with extra X chromosome, tall, learning problems.

QUESTION TWO

a) Distinguish between sensation and perception. [2 marks]

ANSWER:

- Sensation - detecting physical stimuli with your senses
- Perception - interpreting and making sense of sensory information

b) Describe four types of perceptual constancies. [8 marks]

ANSWER:

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1. Size constancy - objects look the same size even when distance changes. Example: a person walking away still looks normal-sized, not shrinking.

2. Shape constancy - objects look the same shape from different angles. Example: a door looks rectangular even when half-open.

3. Brightness constancy - objects look the same brightness in different lighting. Example: white shirt looks white in sunlight or shade.

4. Color constancy - objects keep their color in different lights. Example: banana looks yellow indoors or outdoors.

c) Discuss five factors that influence human perception. [10 marks]

ANSWER:

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1. Past experience - what we've seen before shapes how we see things now. Example: doctors see things in X-rays that others miss.
2. Needs and motivation - what we need affects what we notice. Example: hungry people notice food more.
3. Expectations - what we expect influences what we see. Example: reading "THE CAT" correctly even if letters are unclear.
4. Culture - our background affects perception. Different cultures see things differently.
5. Attention - we clearly see what we focus on. Example: hearing your name in a noisy room (cocktail party effect).

QUESTION THREE

- a) Citing relevant examples, differentiate between primary and secondary motives. [2 marks]

ANSWER:

- Primary motives - biological needs like hunger, thirst, sleep. Example: seeking water when thirsty.
- Secondary motives - learned needs like achievement, belonging. Example: studying for recognition.

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- b) Describe Maslow's Hierarchy of needs and explain how the fulfillment of these needs is relevant to university students. [10 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Physiological needs - food, water, sleep. Students need good meals, housing, rest. Hungry students can't concentrate.
2. Safety needs - security and stability. Students need safe campuses, stable finances, clear rules. Fear blocks learning.
3. Belonging needs - friendships and connections. Students join clubs, make friends, study in groups. Social life helps success.

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4. Esteem needs - respect and achievement. Students get this through good grades, recognition, leadership. Builds confidence.

5. Self-actualization - reaching full potential. Students pursue interests, develop talents, work toward goals. University helps achieve this.

c) With appropriate examples, explain four functions of emotions. [8 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Motivation - emotions push us to act. Example: fear of failing makes you study harder.

2. Communication - emotions show others how we feel. Example: smiling shows friendliness.

3. Survival - emotions prepare body for action. Example: fear triggers fight-or-flight when in danger.

4. Decision-making - emotions guide choices. Example: feeling uneasy about something may warn you to avoid it.

QUESTION FOUR

a) Explain the three aspects of intelligence according to Sternberg. [6 marks]

ANSWER:

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1. Analytical intelligence - ability to analyze and solve problems. Like what IQ tests measure. Example: solving math problems.

2. Creative intelligence - ability to be creative and handle new situations. Example: coming up with new ideas.

3. Practical intelligence - "street smarts," ability to handle everyday problems. Example: dealing with people effectively.

b) Discuss any four causes of mental retardation. [8 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Genetic disorders - like Down syndrome (extra chromosome). Disrupts brain development causing intellectual disability.

2. Prenatal factors - mother's infections, alcohol, drugs, or poor nutrition during pregnancy

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damage baby's brain.

3. Birth problems - lack of oxygen, premature birth, injuries during delivery cause brain damage.

4. After birth - malnutrition, head injuries, infections like meningitis, lead poisoning in childhood cause mental retardation.

c) Discuss any three kinds of partial reinforcement schedules according to B.F. Skinner. [6 marks]

ANSWER:

1. Fixed-ratio - reward after specific number of responses. Example: paid for every 10 items made. Produces fast work with brief pauses.

2. Variable-ratio - reward after unpredictable number of responses. Example: slot machines pay randomly. Produces steady, high response rates.

3. Fixed-interval - reward after fixed time period. Example: paycheck every two weeks. Response increases as payday approaches.

END OF ANSWERS

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